



Commission approves €170 million Bulgarian State aid for farmers facing increased fuel and fertiliser prices

Brussels, 2 October 2026

The European Commission has approved a €170 million Bulgarian State aid scheme for farmers facing increased fuel and fertiliser prices due to the Middle East crisis.

The scheme was approved under the [Middle East Crisis Temporary State Aid Framework \(METSAF\)](#) adopted by the Commission on [29 April 2026](#).

The Bulgarian scheme

Bulgaria notified to the Commission a €170 million scheme to support companies active in the farming sector. The scheme, which will run until 31 December 2026, aims to mitigate the impact of the increase in agricultural fuel and fertiliser prices.

The aid will take the form of **direct grants**. The scheme concerns the granting of a limited amount of aid calibrated on the increase of the prices of fuel and fertilisers, with a maximum of €50,000 per company.

The Commission assessed the scheme under EU State aid rules, in particular [Article 107\(3\)\(c\)](#) of the Treaty on the Functioning of the EU, which enables Member States to support the development of certain economic activities subject to certain conditions, as well as Sections 1 and 2.1 of the METSAF.

The Commission found that the scheme is in line with the conditions set out in the METSAF. In particular, the aid will be granted based on a scheme with a clear estimated budget and will be provided to temporarily support the development of companies active in the primary production of agricultural products. The Commission concluded that the scheme is **necessary, appropriate and proportionate** to facilitate the development of an economic activity and does not adversely affect trading conditions to an extent contrary to the common interest.

On this basis, the Commission approved the Bulgarian scheme under EU State aid rules.

Background

On 29 April 2026, the Commission adopted the [METSAF](#) to enable Member States to support the EU economy in the context of the Middle East crisis. The METSAF is a targeted and temporary framework to address the effects of the crisis on some of the most exposed sectors of the economy: agriculture, fishery, transport and energy-intensive industries. The METSAF will be in place **until 31 December 2026**. During its period of application, the Commission will keep the content, scope and duration of the framework under review in the light of developments in the Middle East and of the general economic situation.

While the transition towards a clean economy remains the long-term solution to shield EU companies from the effects of global energy shocks, the METSAF allows Member States to act immediately to make sure that the growth of the most exposed companies is not irreparably hampered by the current crisis.

To this end, support can take various forms for companies active in the agriculture, fishery and transport sectors. This includes **aid based on actual consumption** to cover part of the price increases for fuel or fertilisers, and **a simplified approach for small amounts of aid**.

The METSAF also includes a temporary adjustment to the [Clean Industrial Deal State aid Framework](#) allowing for further flexibility and higher aid intensities to address electricity price spikes.

[More information](#) on the METSAF can be found online.

For more information

The non-confidential versions of today's decisions will be made available under case number SA.124701, in the [State aid register](#) on the Commission's [competition website](#). New publications of State aid decisions on the internet and in the Official Journal are listed in the [Competition Weekly e-News](#).

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